

Adrian Vellum

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum / Age 38

Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Adrian has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met. He can greet a donor, calm a curator, and redirect a disaster without changing facial expression. Tonight is his biggest gala yet, and he intends for it to look effortless.

- Works closely with Celeste Frame, though the two disagree about how much spectacle a museum should tolerate.
- Relies on Margot Ledger for the numbers and Helena Cross for donor agreements.
- Beatrice Plinth hired Adrian years ago and still occasionally speaks to him as if he were an intern.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Black tie or an immaculate dark suit; museum-lanyard-level precision without actually wearing a lanyard. Optional pocket square, tasteful lapel pin, slim folder or program.

Celeste Frame

Chief Curator of World Cultures / Age 35

Celeste is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive. She is gracious when she chooses to be and devastating when she edits.

- Professional counterpart to Adrian Vellum; they respect each other and routinely disagree.
- Mentors Sebastian Reed, the museum's graduate fellow.
- Frequently consults Rafael Gilt and Dr. Marcus Pryce on difficult objects.

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, quietly competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Elegant gallery-black with one distinctive art-history touch: sculptural jewelry, silk scarf, statement earrings, or beautifully severe glasses. You might carry a pencil and small notebook.

Grant Easel

International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison / Age 36

Grant is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find. Charming, fast-talking, and always perfectly dressed, he insists that art dealing is mostly about trust, discretion, and knowing which flight lands in Geneva before breakfast. He has brokered several loans in tonight's exhibition and knows half the room professionally.

- Has represented Theo Glass in private acquisitions, though neither likes admitting how often they need the other.
- Competes with Conrad Gavel for major consignments.
- Daphne Palette considers him useful but never entirely trustworthy.

ACTING TIPS

Smooth, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Fashion-forward dinner jacket or sharp suit, polished shoes, expensive-looking watch (real or fake), pocket square. Optional slim catalogue with sticky tabs.

Margot Ledger

Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum / Age 33

Margot can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from. She is sharp, stylish, practical, and chronically surrounded by people with expensive visions and no budgets. If the museum survives its ambitions, Margot will probably be the reason.

- Works constantly with Adrian Vellum and Helena Cross.
- Has a friendly rivalry with Riley Bloom, whose gala ideas tend to arrive before their price tags.
- Beatrice Plinth likes Margot because she asks questions trustees hate answering.

ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern cocktail attire or tailored suit; sleek, practical, expensive-looking without being flashy. You might carry a small ledger, calculator, or pen clipped to a folder.

Rafael Gilt

Chief Conservator / Age 39

Rafael is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects from losing arguments with humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. Patient with objects and less patient with humans, he has the calm authority of someone who has seen a priceless painting survive a flood and a donor nearly destroy one with hand lotion. He knows what was repaired, altered, cleaned, and quietly worried over before tonight.

- Works closely with Celeste Frame and Calvin Case.
- Often spars intellectually with Marcus Pryce over what conservation can and cannot prove.
- Beatrice Plinth trusts Rafael's judgment more than most committees.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, tactile, slightly territorial. You care more about what is physically true than what is socially convenient.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Dark suit or smart workwear made gala-appropriate; rolled sleeves under jacket, conservator gloves tucked into a pocket, loupe or small brush as a prop.

Imogen Muse

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity / Age 30

Imogen makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. Her performances have involved mirrored rooms, silent choirs, a twelve-hour dinner party, and once an empty pedestal that sold for more than most houses. She is magnetic, playful, and perfectly capable of making a sincere point while everyone wonders whether they are already inside the piece.

- Former art-school collaborator of Julian Brush; they remain close enough to annoy one another professionally.
- Lola Loom has assisted on several of Imogen's installations.
- Morgan Slate has alternated between praising and savaging Imogen in print.

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: High-fashion black tie with one strange choice: opera gloves, sculptural headpiece, monochrome outfit, dramatic makeup, oversized flower, etc. The goal is 'gallery opening where photographers are present.'

Julian Brush

Celebrated Contemporary Painter / Age 31

Julian became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally. His paintings are lush, moody, and highly collectible; his interviews are less reliable. He is charming, vain in a way he almost gets away with, and genuinely serious about his work when nobody is watching.

- Long creative history with Imogen Muse.
- Malcolm Carrara thinks Julian gets too much press for work that can hang on a wall without engineering permits.
- Daphne Palette owns one of Julian's early paintings and mentions this strategically.

ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Black tie with artist flair: velvet jacket, open collar, paint-spattered vintage shoes, dramatic ring, scarf, or deliberately imperfect formalwear.

Helena Cross

Cultural Property Attorney / Age 34

Helena is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper. She is elegant, surgical, and frighteningly good at making a sentence mean exactly what she intends. Tonight she is attending as counsel to several parties who would prefer not to be described as 'parties.'

- Works regularly with Adrian Vellum and Margot Ledger.
- Friendly professional adversary of Vivienne Marrow; they have argued opposite sides of restitution cases and still have dinner afterward.
- Marcus Pryce has supplied expert opinions for her cases.

ACTING TIPS

Precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Structured formalwear, crisp lines, minimal jewelry, immaculate folder or document case. Optional reading glasses for dramatic removal.

Dr. Marcus Pryce

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar / Age 42

Marcus has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork. Brilliant, argumentative, and allergic to oversimplification, he can turn one stamp on the back of a frame into a forty-minute lecture and somehow make it compelling. Treasures of the World contains several objects he has researched personally.

- Supervises Sebastian Reed's doctoral research.
- Debates restitution policy regularly with Vivienne Marrow and Juno March.
- Rafael Gilt is one of the few people Marcus trusts to tell him when physical evidence contradicts his theory.

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Professor at a donor gala: dark suit, tweed or textured jacket, distinctive glasses, scholarly scarf, pocket notebook. Optional magnifier or archival pencil.

Sienna Voss

Philanthropist & Heir to the Voss Family Fortune / Age 29

Sienna is the only member of the Voss dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone waits several minutes first. She is stylish, socially fluent, and harder to read than her public image suggests. She funds young artists, hates being introduced as an heiress, and has learned to smile through questions about her family.

- Moves in the same collector circle as Theo Glass and Daphne Palette.
- Has commissioned work from Imogen Muse.
- Beatrice Plinth has known Sienna since childhood and refuses to be impressed by her surname.

ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern gala glamour: elegant cocktail dress or formal suit, statement jewelry, designer-looking clutch, effortless rather than ostentatious.

Everett Locke

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator /
Age 37

Everett spent years investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control. He is calm, observant, and difficult to surprise. He notices open doors, blocked sight lines, unattended bags, and people who suddenly become interested in exits. Tonight he would prefer everyone simply enjoy the exhibition, which means they almost certainly will not.

- Coordinates closely with Adrian Vellum and Rafael Gilt.
- Frequently clashes with Nadia Quill over access and with Juno March over protest tactics.
- Riley Bloom keeps changing layouts after Everett has already approved them.

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Dark suit, discreet earpiece prop if desired, security-style watch, small notebook. A senior museum security look could work well.

Nadia Quill

Investigative Arts Journalist / Age 32

Nadia covers the art world the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees not to ask a question. Her pieces are sharp, deeply sourced, and occasionally followed by nervous legal letters. She has been invited tonight because excluding her would look worse.

- Professional rival of Morgan Slate, whose criticism Nadia considers entertaining but insufficiently documented.
- Avery Lens has photographed several of Nadia's stories.
- Helena Cross has threatened to quote Nadia's own articles back to her in court.

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Cocktail attire with practical reporter touches: blazer, notebook, pen, compact camera if desired. Stylish enough for the gala, ready enough for a press scrum.

Treasures of the World

Lucian Gable

Exhibition Architect & Designer / Age 34

Lucian designed the physical experience of Treasures of the World: every wall angle, sight line, spotlight, pedestal, and dramatic reveal. He is tasteful, exacting, and deeply convinced that visitors would behave better if they understood circulation. He has strong opinions about fonts, cords, and anything that interrupts a clean visual field.

- Creative rival of sculptor Malcolm Carrara after a very public argument about scale.
- Works constantly with Riley Bloom, who keeps trying to add flowers where Lucian designed negative space.
- Rafael Gilt has veto power over several of Lucian's more adventurous display ideas.

ACTING TIPS

Aesthetic, controlled, mildly pretentious in a lovable way, easily offended by bad placement rather than bad manners.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Architectural formalwear: monochrome suit, turtleneck with jacket, sharply cut black attire, interesting glasses, rolled plans or a small laser measure prop.

Vivienne Marrow

International Cultural Heritage Envoy / Age 38

Vivienne moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural' while bringing three lawyers. She is poised, persuasive, and very difficult to rush. Her work focuses on contested cultural property and long-term international loans.

- Long-running professional friendship and rivalry with Helena Cross.
- Frequently debates Marcus Pryce and Juno March on how restitution should actually work.
- Adrian Vellum has courted her support for several international partnerships.

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Refined diplomatic formalwear; jewel tones, elegant suit or dress, subtle cultural or heritage-inspired accessory worn respectfully. Optional slim portfolio.

Theo Glass

Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron / Age 35

Theo made a fortune building software and has spent the last five years trying to become the sort of collector whose taste is discussed rather than merely his net worth. He is enthusiastic, competitive, and genuinely knowledgeable enough to resent anyone who assumes otherwise. His collection mixes contemporary art, design, and objects he describes as 'historically underpriced.'

- Buys through Grant Easel more often than either admits.
- Runs in the same social orbit as Sienna Voss and Daphne Palette.
- Morgan Slate once described his collection as 'an algorithm discovering patina,' which Theo has not forgotten.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, socially confident, competitive, eager to demonstrate taste without looking eager.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern black tie with tech-founder looseness: excellent jacket, minimal sneakers or polished shoes, unusual watch, bold glasses. Optional auction paddle as a joke prop.

Beatrice Plinth

Founding Curator Emerita / Age 84

Beatrice helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers. She is sharp, unsentimental, impossible to flatter, and delighted that everyone now treats decisions she made on folding tables as institutional history.

- Hired Adrian Vellum early in his career.
- Trusts Rafael Gilt and Maya Bell.
- Has known Sienna Voss since Sienna was a child.

ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Old-school gala elegance: brooch, gloves, shawl, pearls, cane if desired, formal suit or dress with unmistakable presence.

Conrad Gavel

Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House / Age 63

Conrad has sold paintings, antiquities, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider. Urbane and ceremonious, he treats every conversation like a private viewing and every silence like a bidding strategy.

- Longtime professional rival of Grant Easel.
- Knows Daphne Palette and Theo Glass from the auction circuit.
- Beatrice Plinth remembers when Conrad was still carrying catalogues for someone else.

ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Classic tuxedo or formal dark suit, silk pocket square, signet ring, reading glasses, optional miniature auction gavel.

Lola Loom

Textile Artist & Designer / Age 27

Lola turns weaving, embroidery, salvage fabric, and obsessive handwork into installations that critics call intimate and collectors call surprisingly difficult to ship. She is warm, observant, and capable of discussing thread count with the intensity of a military briefing.

- Has assisted Imogen Muse on several installations.
- Friendly with Julian Brush from the local art circuit.
- Rafael Gilt has advised her on displaying fragile textiles.

ACTING TIPS

Creative, grounded, quietly funny, detail-oriented. You notice what people wear and how things are made.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Formal outfit with texture: embroidered jacket, woven scarf, textile jewelry, patterned dress, unusual fabric. Handmade touches encouraged.

Sebastian Reed

Doctoral Fellow in Art History / Age 24

Sebastian is the youngest scholar attached to the exhibition and has been trying very hard to behave like this is normal. He is brilliant, earnest, slightly overprepared, and burdened with the knowledge that every person here could someday write a recommendation letter or ruin his evening.

- Doctoral student of Marcus Pryce.
- Mentored informally by Celeste Frame.
- Maya Bell keeps rescuing Sebastian from conversations with donors who ask whether art history is a real degree.

ACTING TIPS

Eager, cerebral, anxious in a useful way, unexpectedly bold when the evidence is on your side.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Best-suit energy: formal but slightly less effortless than the veterans. Optional extras: glasses, a notebook or a museum catalogue full of tabs.

Malcolm Carrara

Sculptor & Public-Art Star / Age 36

Malcolm makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane. He is charismatic, physically expressive, and convinced that architecture should know when to get out of sculpture's way. His newest commission occupies the museum entrance and at least three opinions per square foot.

- Creative rival of Lucian Gable after an argument about the entrance installation.
- Friendly competitor of Julian Brush.
- Riley Bloom once designed a gala around one of Malcolm's sculptures and still talks about the insurance.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Bold formalwear, chunky ring, sculptural accessories, dark shirt with jacket, perhaps a dust-marked work boot paired with gala clothes.

Daphne Palette

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture / Age 33

Daphne has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year. She hosts salons, funds commissions, and somehow makes every acquisition look accidental. Beneath the polish, she is a serious collector who remembers exactly who dismissed what five years ago.

- Collects work by Julian Brush and Lola Loom.
- Competes socially and at auction with Theo Glass.
- Uses Grant Easel when discretion matters and Conrad Gavel when spectacle does.

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Fashion-forward gala look, statement jewelry, dramatic clutch, bold color or silhouette. For inspiration, think of 'photographed on arrival.'

Morgan Slate

Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster / Age 30

Morgan can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment. Their reviews are incisive, funny, and widely read; their podcast is where the art world goes to hear itself discussed by someone who may not be impressed.

- Friendly rival of Nadia Quill.
- Has reviewed Julian Brush, Imogen Muse, Malcolm Carrara, and Lola Loom.
- Theo Glass remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Smart, artsy formalwear: black with one eccentric element, distinctive glasses, scarf, vintage jacket, notebook. Gender presentation entirely flexible.

Felix Savoy

Head Caterer & Hospitality Director / Age 41

Felix runs high-end events with the serene expression of a person mentally tracking forty-seven moving parts. He knows who asked for the vegan plate, who changed the seating chart, who is pretending not to be hungry, and exactly how long a tray can sit before someone complains.

- Works closely with Riley Bloom and Margot Ledger.
- Everett Locke has made Felix revise service routes repeatedly for security reasons.
- Adrian Vellum trusts Felix to keep donors fed while everyone else panics.

ACTING TIPS

Competent, sociable, quietly authoritative, hard to rattle. You see the room from the service side.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Sharp black suit or upscale catering uniform, tie or bow tie, folded service towel, small order pad. A luxury event professional could be your inspiration.

Calvin Case

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist / Age 32

Calvin is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either. He knows crates, rigging, mounts, gloves, freight elevators, and exactly which curators become unbearable during installation week. Practical and calm, he is one of the few people in the room who has physically touched most of the exhibition.

- Works daily with Rafael Gilt.
- Has developed mutual respect with Lucian Gable despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- Malcolm Carrara likes Calvin because Calvin actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Clean dark workwear dressed up for a gala: black trousers, sturdy shoes, smart shirt/jacket, work gloves tucked in pocket, measuring tape prop.

Maya Bell

Director of Education & Docent Programs / Age 29

Maya is responsible for making the museum intelligible to people who did not spend twelve years specializing in one dynasty. Warm, quick, and occasionally subversive, she can turn an academic argument into a great tour question and a donor speech into something children will actually remember.

- Close to Beatrice Plinth, who champions the education program.
- Often rescues Sebastian Reed from awkward public-facing moments.
- Works with Celeste Frame to translate scholarship into gallery interpretation.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Colorful cocktail attire or polished museum-professional look, comfortable shoes, fun brooch or earrings, optional stack of tour cards.

Avery Lens

Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist / Age 28

Avery photographs artists, collectors, and public figures for magazines that describe parties like tonight as 'intimate' despite inviting two hundred people. They are quiet when working, socially fluent when not, and very good at being present without becoming the center of the frame.

- Has photographed several investigations for Nadia Quill.
- Imogen Muse loves Avery's work because Avery does not overdirect.
- Daphne Palette always knows which side Avery is shooting from.

ACTING TIPS

Observant, understated, curious, visually minded. You notice who is standing with whom and what happens at the edge of a room.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Elegant all-black or dark cocktail wear, camera as the key prop if available, comfortable shoes, press-style shoulder bag.

Juno March

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer / Age 35

Juno campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation. She is articulate, strategic, and much more interested in leverage than theatrics—although she knows theatrics can create leverage.

- Frequently debates Marcus Pryce and Vivienne Marrow on strategy.
- Everett Locke has removed Juno from a museum event before; both remember it.
- Maya Bell quietly agrees with more of Juno's critique than museum leadership suspects.

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Smart gala attire with activist edge: bold pin, statement scarf, printed tote, elegant suit or dress. A bold accessory may be all you need.

Penny Varnish

Eccentric Private Collector / Age 62

Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did. She is wealthy enough to ignore trends and old enough to enjoy doing so publicly. Penny has a habit of wandering away from tours and returning with better information than the guide provided.

- Old friend of Beatrice Plinth.
- Knows Conrad Gavel from decades of auctions.
- Daphne Palette alternates between finding Penny inspiring and alarming.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Eclectic formalwear: vintage jewelry, dramatic brooches, velvet, patterned jacket, gloves, small opera glasses or fan.

Leo Taggart

Tulsa Arts Columnist & Local Historian / Age 30

Leo knows which gallery used to be a bank, which donor funded which wing, and which local art feud is still alive despite everyone involved pretending otherwise. His column is affectionate, gossipy, and read by exactly the people who claim they never read it.

- Has profiled Adrian Vellum and Beatrice Plinth.
- Friendly with Maya Bell and Avery Lens.
- Nadia Quill considers Leo useful when she needs Tulsa context and dangerous when he starts telling stories.

ACTING TIPS

Friendly, curious, locally knowledgeable, a little nosy. You connect people and remember old stories.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Cocktail suit or blazer, vintage Tulsa flair if desired, notebook, press card prop, old museum brochure tucked into pocket.

Treasures of the World

Riley Bloom

Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer / Age 32

Riley creates the visual spectacle around events like tonight: flowers, lighting, table styling, entrances, reveals, and the precise moment everyone is supposed to gasp. They are exuberant, fast-moving, and convinced that restraint is wonderful when somebody else is responsible for it.

- Works constantly with Lucian Gable, who removes half of Riley's ideas.
- Felix Savoy is Riley's favorite partner in event logistics.
- Margot Ledger is the person who asks what Riley's ideas cost.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, aesthetic, affectionate, slightly chaotic but highly competent. You notice atmosphere first.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Creative formalwear: floral pin, velvet jacket, unusual bow tie, colorful suit, statement glasses. Optional ribbon swatches or mini lighting plan.

October 30, 2026 / Meridian Museum Gala